Romantic Era & Early 20th-Century Music
Exam Review

Music 101 · Intro to Music

NAME _____ DATE _____ SCORE / 36

Read each direction before you start. Write clearly in pen or pencil.

Short answer

4 pts each

Answer in two to four complete sentences.

1 How does Schubert's *Erlking* portray its characters and the galloping horse?

2 Explain the difference between program music and absolute music.

3 How is the idée fixe presented in movement V of the *Symphonie fantastique*, and what does it represent?

4 How did Brahms's *A German Requiem* differ from the traditional Requiem?

5 Why was a conductor needed in the Romantic era, and which instruments were added to the orchestra?

6 What role did the piano play in 19th-century life?

7 What characterizes Impressionist music?

8 Describe the musical features of Joplin's *Maple Leaf Rag*.

9 How did the Industrial Revolution and the piano shape musical life in the 19th century?

Answer key

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KEY POINTS

1. One singer portrays four characters (narrator, father, son and the Erlking), and repeated piano triplets depict the galloping horse.
2. Program music is instrumental music with a literary or pictorial association; absolute music lacks any literary or pictorial association.
3. It is distorted and grotesque, played on a shrill clarinet. The idée fixe is Berlioz's recurring theme representing the beloved.
4. Brahms used German Bible texts instead of the Latin liturgy.
5. The larger Romantic orchestra created the need for a conductor. New instruments were the piccolo, English horn, tuba and contrabassoon.
6. It was central to home life; families gathered around the piano to make and hear music.
7. Unresolved dissonances, blurred harmonies and shimmering orchestral color, rather than a strong pull to the tonic or a strong rhythmic drive.
8. A ragtime piece originally for piano: a syncopated right-hand melody over a steady "oom-pah" left hand.
9. The Industrial Revolution brought technical improvements to instruments that changed the Romantic sound, and the piano was central to home life, where families gathered to make and hear music.

Print this page separately so the key isn't handed out with the quiz.